

Course 5 overview

0:22 / 7:20

Hello! Welcome to the fifth of the seven courses in the [Google Project Management Certificate program](#). [↗](#)



1. **Foundations of Project Management** — Learn the fundamentals of project management and how this program will prepare you for project management roles in numerous types of industries. Then, explore the different types of career paths you might pursue, the responsibilities and essential skills of a project manager, the importance of the project life cycle, common project management methodologies, and how organizational structure and culture impact project management.
2. **Project Initiation: Starting a Successful Project**— Discover how to set the stage for a successful project. Learn about stakeholders, their level of influence, and how to mobilize and manage them, as well as tackle tasks to identify project scope, goals, deliverables, and success criteria.
3. **Project Planning: Putting it All Together**— Explore how to map out a project in the second phase of the project life cycle: the project planning phase. Examine the key components of a project plan, how to make accurate time estimates, and how to set milestones.
4. **Project Execution: Running the Project**— Delve into the execution and closing phases of the project life cycle. Learn what aspects of a project to track and how to track them, as well as how to effectively manage and communicate changes, dependencies, and risks.

5. **Agile Project Management—** (*current course*) Explore the history, approach, and philosophy of Agile project management, including the Scrum framework. Learn how to differentiate and blend Agile and other project management approaches. Discover more about Scrum, exploring its pillars and values and comparing essential Scrum team roles.
6. **Capstone: Applying Project Management in the Real World—** Develop a portfolio of project management artifacts that will demonstrate the skills you have learned throughout the entire program, such as your ability to manage stakeholders and teams, organize plans, and communicate project details.
7. **Accelerate Your Job Search with AI—** Gain practical job search strategies and learn how to leverage AI tools (like Gemini and NotebookLM) to uncover your most valuable skills, create a job search plan, manage your applications, and practice for interviews as you navigate your path to your next role.

This course will explore the history, approach, and philosophy of Agile project management, including the Scrum framework. You will learn how to differentiate and blend Agile and other project management approaches. As you progress through the course, you will learn more about Scrum, exploring its pillars and values and comparing essential Scrum team roles. You will discover how to build, manage, and refine a Product Backlog, implement Agile's value-driven delivery strategies, and define a Value Roadmap. You will also develop the skills to organize the five important Scrum events for a Scrum team, introduce an Agile or Scrum approach to an organization, and coach an Agile team. Finally, you will learn how to search for and land opportunities in Agile roles. Current Google project managers will continue to instruct and provide you with the hands-on approaches, tools, and resources to meet your goals.

In this reading, you will learn about the Project Management Certificate program structure and course functionality. If you already read this in the last course and don't need a refresher, feel free to skip it. If you're new to the program, welcome! We've specifically designed the program you're about to explore to help every type of learner successfully finish the certificate and get ready for a role in project management. No previous experience is required.

Become job-ready

In this Google Project Management Certificate program, you will learn the foundations of traditional project management and gain insight into Agile project management. According to the Project Management Institute, the project management labor force in seven project-oriented sectors is expected to grow by 33 percent, or nearly 22 million new jobs, by 2027*. We are excited to join you on this journey as you learn the skills to begin a career in one of today's most in-demand professions.

Course 5 covers four modules of material. Each module includes a series of lessons with many types of learning opportunities, such as:

- **Videos** with a Google employee as your instructor.
- **Readings** to introduce new ideas and case studies and to build on the concepts from the videos.
- **Connect with other learners:** If you have a question, chances are, you're not alone. You can visit Coursera's private [Project Management Community](#) to expand your network, discuss career journeys, and share experiences. Check out the [quick start guide](#).
- **In-video questions** that will pop up from time to time. They're designed for you to check your learning as you go!
- **Practice quizzes** to check your understanding and give you valuable feedback. **Practice activities** will provide you with a hands-on opportunity to apply skills you are working to master. You will assess your work by answering quiz questions about it or by comparing it to an exemplar built by our course team. *Note: these activities will not count towards your final course grade, but you are strongly encouraged to complete them as they will help prepare you for the graded quizzes and peer reviews.*
- **Graded quizzes** on video and reading content to measure your progress.
- Ungraded **peer-review activities** on video and reading content that provide you the opportunity to practice applying skills you are working to master. Other learners in your course will see the work you submit and give you feedback based on a rubric.
- **Graded peer-review activities** on video and reading content that assess your ability to apply skills you are working to master. Other learners in your course will grade your work and give you feedback based on a rubric.

Everyone learns differently, so we designed this program to let you work at your own pace. Although your personalized deadlines start when you enroll, they're just a guide. Feel free to move through the program however it works best for you. Keep in mind, you can always reset your deadlines by clicking the blue **reset my deadlines** button. There's no penalty for late assignments. To earn your certificate, all you have to do is complete all of the work.

Tips

- We strongly recommend you take all six courses—and complete the items in each lesson—in the order they appear, as new information and concepts build on previous ones.
- Make the most of the readings and additional resources throughout the program. They're designed to support your learning.
- If something is confusing, don't hesitate to rewatch a video, go through a reading again, or ask your classmates for advice in the Community.
- Take part in all learning opportunities to gain as much knowledge and experience possible.

Congratulations on choosing to take this first step toward becoming a part of the wonderful world of project management. Enjoy the journey!

**Source: PMI (2017). Project Management Job Growth and Talent Gap 2017–2027.*